



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	14 May 2024	Time of Incident	6:37am
Directorate / Region	RMO – Metropolitan	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads
EQSafe Event Type	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	40534
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Worker injured whilst repairing wire ropes, resulting in LTI.
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Executive Summary

The morning of 14 May 2024, a crew were scheduled on night shift to replace damaged posts on wire rope on a highway. After installation of the posts, they were inserting wire back into the post using a crowbar. During this process, the Injured Person (IP) has felt a sudden yank in their shoulder, The IP has continued working the remaining time on that shift. The next day they felt pain in their shoulder. The IP worked the following two shifts without reporting the injury. Five-day post incident, during their rostered days off the IP rang a supervisor to report the incident and injury.

The IP has attended a local medical clinic, where the Doctor declared them unfit for work for two weeks.

After further investigation, it was found that correct processes in the Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) were not being followed for the task including not de-tensioning the wire and not using the correct tools. It was also found that three crew members had been scheduled for this task, however one had gone home sick leaving only two crew members to complete the removal and repairs.



De-tension tool used to de-tension wire to reduce wire rope pressure



Post puller used to get damaged posts out of sleeve.

Contributing Factors

- Hazards such as the wire tension and not using the de-tensioner and post puller were not recognised and assessed.
- The IP did not follow the SWMS detailing the correct use of tooling for wire rope repairs.
- The IP did not follow Incident Reporting Procedures by not notifying the supervisor immediately of the shoulder injury.
- Crews should not have been sent out to complete the task with one crew member down. The task should have been rescheduled for next shift.

Corrective Actions

- Provide sessions on Incident Reporting Procedures at Toolbox meetings.
- Review and update SWMS/Safe Work Instructions (SWI) relating to wire rope repairs.
- Subject Matter Experts (SME's) to provide training to crew on the use of de-tensioning tooling.
- Update rostering procedures to ensure crews have sufficient resources (people/tools) for tasks and planning.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Crew leaders need to ensure checks that the correct equipment is available and suitable for use, and that there are enough resources to safely complete a task.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations